PROJECT 3 OF 3 / UX MENTORSHIP

NETFLIX

From browsing to belonging

A content discovery concept for people who know they want to watch something, but do not want to spend the evening deciding.

Research framing, proto-persona, JTBD, competitor scan, journey, IA, flows, wireframes, interface direction, clickable prototype and validation plan.

UX CASE STUDY / 27 OCTOBER 2026

INDEPENDENT CONCEPT / NOT AFFILIATED WITH NETFLIX

00 / OVERVIEW

Make the next good choice easier to see

Design opportunity: help limited-time viewers move from vague intent to a confident Play decision with less backtracking.

PROBLEM

Choice costs attention

A simple evening choice can become work when candidates hide runtime, language, and tone.

CONCEPT

Tonight, quickly

Set time, language, and mood, then compare a short list with visible reasons for fit.

OUTCOME TO TEST

Less search, more confidence

Measure success, time, backtracking, and confidence. No improvement is claimed before real sessions.

SUBMISSION ARTIFACTS

DISCOVER

Research + competitor scan

DEFINE

Persona, JTBD, HMW

STRUCTURE

Journey, IA, flows

DESIGN

Wireframes + interface

VALIDATE

Prototype + test kit

EVIDENCE STATUS

Concept design is complete. Primary interviews and participant usability tests have not been conducted. Scenario details and persona traits are labeled assumptions.

00 / OVERVIEW

The brief is a discovery-to-play problem

Scope includes the moments that shape a decision: orient, narrow, evaluate, save, start, and return.

ASSIGNMENT INTENT

Spend less time searching.

Make content discovery easier, faster, and more engaging by understanding behavior, decision fatigue, user journeys, wireframes, prototyping, and validation.

DESIGN QUESTION

What should I watch now?

How might we help someone identify a title that fits tonight without comparing the whole catalog?

IN SCOPE

DISCOVERY	Intent chips and relevant rows
EVALUATION	Runtime, language, tone, synopsis
CONTROL	Save, compare, change filters
PLAY	Clear playback handoff

OUT OF SCOPE

- Production UI or live Netflix catalog
- Recommendation algorithm claims
- Streaming, billing, or account engineering
- Concept titles represented as real catalog

Mobile-first responsive concept; the interaction model can adapt to TV browsing patterns.

01 / DISCOVER

Separate what we know from what we need to learn

A credible case study distinguishes public product facts, project assumptions, design choices, and outcomes.

PUBLIC PRODUCT CONTEXT	Netflix says recommendations use viewing activity, similar-member patterns, title information, and context; home rows and ranking are personalized.	SOURCE-SUPPORTED
PROJECT HYPOTHESES	People with little time may value runtime, language, mood, and an easy return path over one more broad row.	TO VALIDATE
DESIGN RESPONSE	Offer optional intent filters and show why each concept title fits those needs.	CONCEPT DECISION
OUTCOME CLAIMS	No interviews, analytics, or participant usability sessions were run for this artifact.	NOT CLAIMED
METHOD NOTE	Persona and scenarios are provisional. No participant quotes are invented. The kit contains a script and recording sheet for real discovery.	

Research plan: learn how the choice happens

Three short interviews and a moderated prototype test are the minimum validation plan, not results already collected.

RECRUIT

Three current viewers

Mix solo and shared viewing. Include someone who regularly uses non-default audio or subtitles if feasible.

METHOD

20-minute interview

Ask about the last real selection moment. Follow the action sequence; do not ask only what they might do.

CAPTURE

Behavior, not preference alone

Record intent, filters, titles compared, returns, time, confidence, and points of uncertainty.

NEUTRAL INTERVIEW GUIDE

1. Think about the last time you opened Netflix and were not sure what to watch. What happened?
2. What did you already know about your time, mood, or who was watching?
3. What did you look at before choosing? What made you rule a title in or out?
4. Did you search, browse, ask someone, or return to a saved title? Show me if you can.
5. How did you know the title was a good fit? What was still uncertain?

Ask for a concrete last-use example. Introduce concept filters only after the discovery story.

Competitor scan: compare patterns, not scores

Directional desk scan of public help and product material; not a hands-on or measured comparison.

SERVICE	PUBLIC PATTERN	DESIGN LEARNING	OPPORTUNITY
Netflix	Personalized rows and ranking; audio/subtitles can be selected; My Netflix collects saved and in-progress titles on supported surfaces.	Personalization and return paths are core discovery infrastructure.	Make shortlist intent and fit cues explicit in one route.
Prime Video	Profiles, title details, playback language/captions, and related help appear in public support material.	Profiles and language controls matter across discovery and playback.	Surface language availability before commitment.
JioHotstar	Public accessibility material covers search, home, series, watch, movies, categories, and My Space in evaluated interfaces.	Discovery needs to work across entry points and access needs.	Keep labels, focus states, and handoff understandable.

LIMITATION Public pages support these narrow descriptions only; they do not establish usability, performance, or satisfaction. Source links are in the appendix and research kit.

Proto-persona: Meera, the after-work viewer

Scenario composite from the brief. Validate with viewers before treating it as representative.

MEERA

Proto-persona / 27 / scenario

AFTER WORK

"I want something that fits tonight without turning choosing into another task."

CONTEXT

Short evening window

Usually has a time budget; sometimes shares the screen with a partner or family.

GOAL

Choose with confidence

Wants to see why a title fits without opening many detail pages.

FRICTION HYPOTHESIS

Too many near matches

Broad rows may not reveal runtime, language, or tone early enough.

NEED

Keep a useful shortlist

Save a maybe, compare a few options, and return without losing intent.

Assumptions: 30-45 minutes; mobile-to-TV use; preferences vary by night.

02 / DEFINE

Define the job, tension, and design question

Center the context and desired progress, not a feature request.

JOB TO BE DONE

When I have limited time and a rough sense of what I feel like watching, I want to quickly identify a title that fits my time, language, and mood, so I can feel good about pressing Play instead of continuing to browse.

FUNCTIONAL

Find the right fit

Narrow options and evaluate titles with enough context.

EMOTIONAL

Feel sure enough to start

Reduce the fear that a better choice is hidden elsewhere.

SOCIAL

Agree when watching together

Make tone and language visible so viewers can align.

PROBLEM STATEMENT

Viewers may invest more attention comparing candidates than they want to spend. Existing product signals may not be easy to use as a route from personal intention to a confident choice.

HOW MIGHT WE

Help a limited-time viewer find a title that feels right without inspecting the entire catalog?

02 / DEFINE

Three opportunity hypotheses guide the concept

These are questions to test, not findings from completed interviews.

HYPOTHESIS 01

RELEVANCE

A recommendation needs to explain its fit.

VALIDATION QUESTION

Does a concise reason help someone shortlist?

HYPOTHESIS 02

CONFIDENCE

Runtime, language, and mood may be decision signals.

VALIDATION QUESTION

Which signals are sought before opening details?

HYPOTHESIS 03

CONTROL

Save and compare may reduce costly backtracking.

VALIDATION QUESTION

Can someone change direction and return easily?

SYNTHESIS AFTER INTERVIEWS

- Tag observed behavior, not inferred personality.
- Keep participant quote separate from interpretation.
- Group friction by browse, evaluate, return, and play.
- Revise hypotheses when evidence disagrees.

Journey: from maybe to Play and back again

Evaluation and the return loop are the moments where a compact decision route may help.

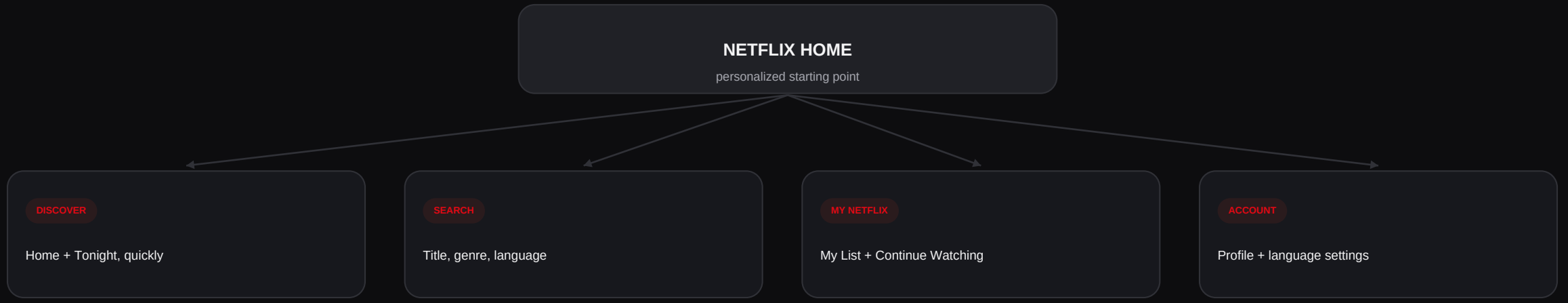
OPEN	BROWSE	EVALUATE	DECIDE	PLAY	RETURN
Set context →	**Scan options** →	**Check fit** →	**Choose one** →	**Start** →	**Resume / save**
ACTION					
Open app	Scan home	Open 2-3 titles	Choose or save	Press Play	Resume/revisit
QUESTION					
What fits?	Where to look?	Will I enjoy it?	Better option?	Audio right?	Where is my pick?
FRICTION					
No intent	Many rows	Info arrives late	Decision fatigue	Language surprise	Lost shortlist
OPPORTUNITY					
Capture needs	Show fit cues	Compare signals	Confirm fit	Expose audio	Keep My List

"I know why this fits, and I can change my mind without starting over."

03 / STRUCTURE

Keep familiar routes; add a guided discovery lens

The concept complements Browse, Search, and My List. It does not require a new permanent product area.



FLOW: OPEN > OPTIONAL FILTERS > SCAN FIT CUES > TITLE DETAILS > PLAY OR SAVE

TIME	Under 30 / under 60 / any
LANGUAGE	Audio / subtitles
MOOD	Light / tense / thoughtful / any
COMPANY	Solo / shared / unspecified

Optional, reversible filters. Standard Search and My List remain easy to reach.

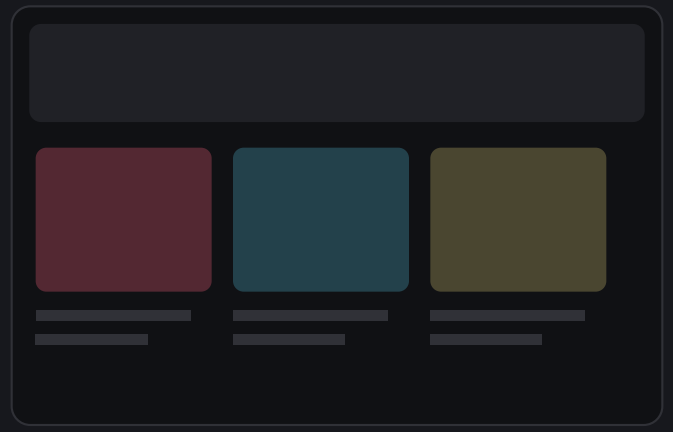
04 / DESIGN

Three wireframes answer the assignment brief

The hierarchy puts decision signals before decorative detail.

01 / DISCOVERY

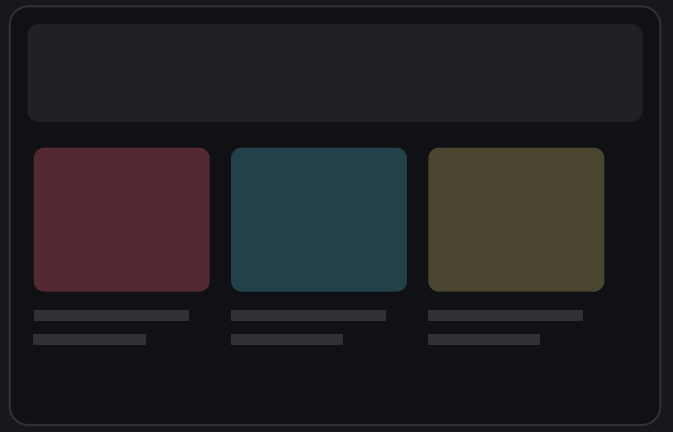
What fits tonight?



- Intent chips: time, language, mood
- Short list with distinct candidates
- Runtime and audio visible
- Why-this-fits cue
- Save and details actions

02 / TITLE DETAILS

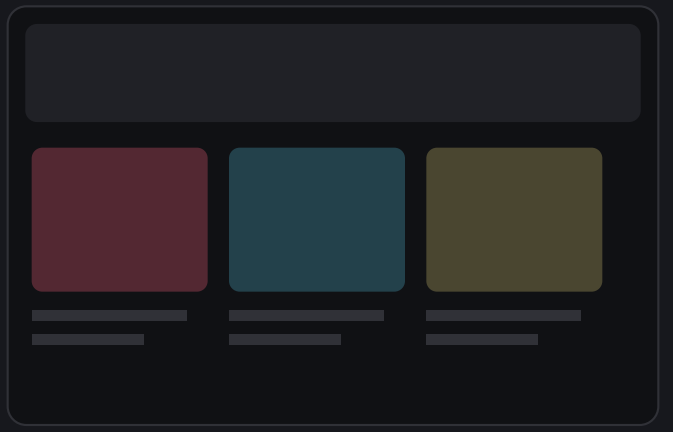
Is this the one?



- Hero and clear title identity
- Runtime, genre, maturity
- Audio and subtitle availability
- Short synopsis and fit summary
- Play and My List actions

03 / DECISION SUPPORT

Help me choose



- Compare up to three titles
- Time, language, mood fit
- Concise differences, not score alone
- Explain missing metadata
- Play one or save all

LOW-FI STRUCTURE

CLICKABLE ROUTE IN INDEX.HTML

04 / DESIGN

Visual language: cinematic, calm, legible

Use familiar dark surfaces and restrained red emphasis; never let color carry meaning alone.

TOKENS

CANVAS	#0D0D0F
SURFACE	#17181D
ELEVATED	#202126
TEXT	#F4F4F5
MUTED	#A7A8B0
ACCENT	#E50914

COMPONENT RULES

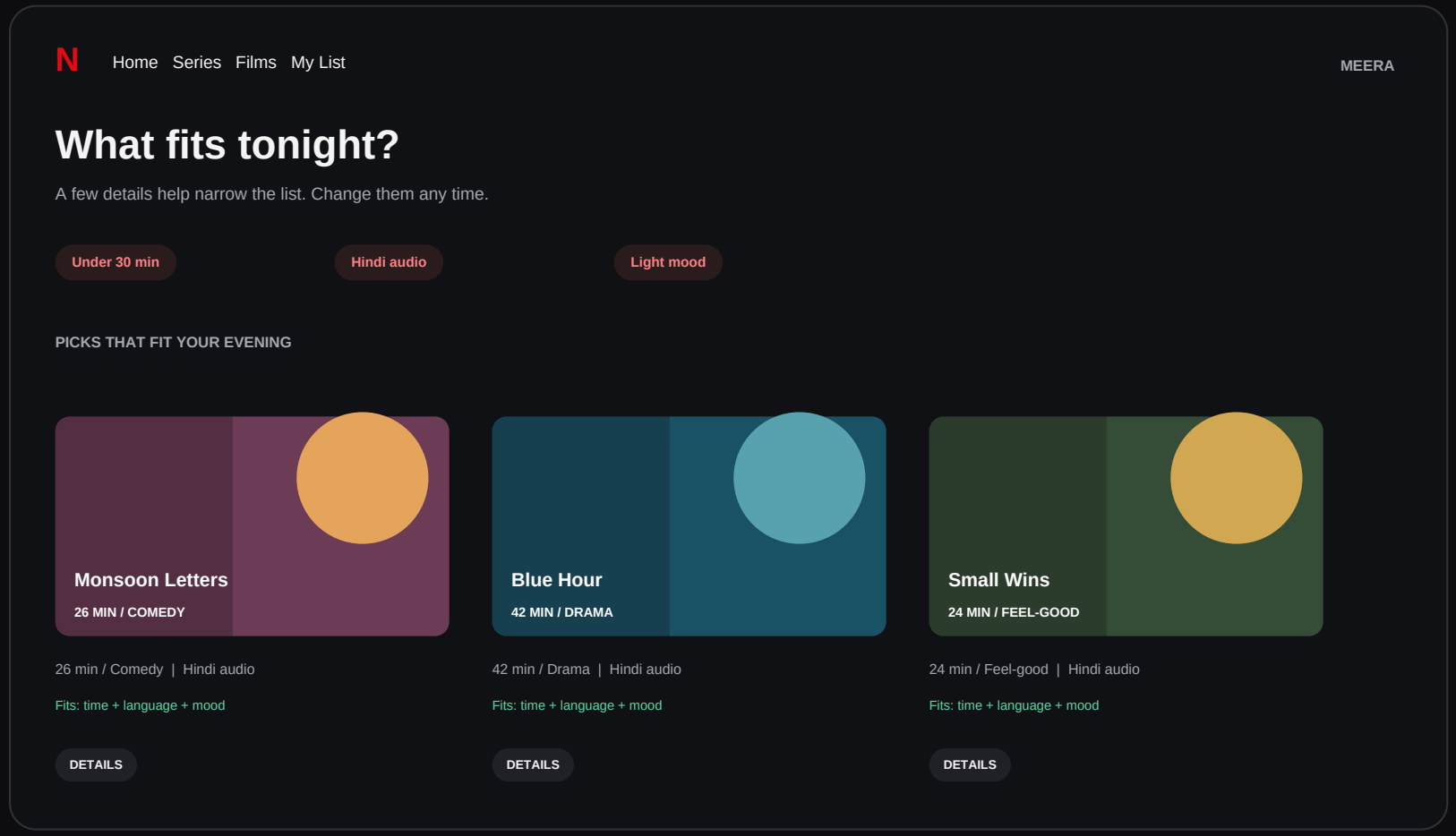
POSTER	Title + metadata beyond artwork.
FILTER	Selected state uses label + shape.
FIT CUE	Short reason tied to stated intent.
SAVE	Button label changes to Saved.

ACCESSIBILITY

- Visible keyboard focus and text labels.
- Readable metadata and scalable type.
- Semantic headings, buttons, and live feedback.
- No autoplay; poster art is not the only cue.

Screen 01: discovery that reflects the night

Illustrative UI. The runnable prototype uses invented titles and local data.



WHY THIS HIERARCHY

Intent comes first

Set constraints before the catalog fills the page. Filters remain optional and visible.

WHY SHOW A REASON

Relevant at a glance

A concise fit cue helps compare options without opening every detail page.

Concept content; not a Netflix catalog claim.

Screen 02: make fit inspectable before Play

A title screen should make expectations visible and save the viewer a return trip.

Warm comedy / 26 min / Hindi audio

A quiet change of plans brings two neighbors together

On a rain-soaked evening, two neighbors trade small favors and discover a new way to feel at home.

PLAY + MY LIST

Audio: Hindi / Subtitles: English available

COMPARE A FEW

Only the signals that help you choose.

MONSOON LETTERS
26 min / Hindi
Light comedy

BLUE HOUR
42 min / Hindi
Quiet drama

SMALL WINS
24 min / Hindi
Feel-good

DECISION SUPPORT

Small comparison set

Three options keep differences useful without creating another endless list.

06 / VALIDATE

Usability test: can three viewers find a fit?

Moderated task-based evaluation with three people. Record behavior and confidence; do not coach.

TASK 01

You have about half an hour and want something light in Hindi. Find a title you would consider playing.

TASK 02

You are not ready now. Save a title, then show me where you would return to it.

TASK 03

Compare two options and tell me what would make you choose one.

CAPTURE PER PERSON

SUCCESS

Independent / assisted / not done

TIME

Start to suitable Play or saved return

CONFUSION

Misclicks, backtracking, questions

CONFIDENCE

1-5 after each task; ask why

RECRUIT

Three current viewers

Vary language and shared-viewing habits if feasible.

NO RESULT CLAIM YET

No participant sessions have been run. A blank worksheet is in the research kit.

06 / VALIDATE

Three scenario rehearsals close the loop

AI-assisted walkthroughs inspect task clarity and controls. They are not participant testing or usability results.

01 / FIND A FIT

Prompt: about 30 min, something light, Hindi audio.

SCENARIO PATH

Route: choose time + mood + language; compare Monsoon Letters and Small Wins; inspect details; reach the concept Play state.

DESIGN CHECK

Check: runtime, audio, and fit reasons are visible before the detail page.

02 / SAVE FOR LATER

Prompt: not ready to watch now.

SCENARIO PATH

Route: save a title; see Saved feedback; open My List; reopen the saved title.

DESIGN CHECK

Check: confirmation and return location are unmistakable.

03 / COMPARE

Prompt: compare two choices and explain the difference.

SCENARIO PATH

Route: select Blue Hour + Small Wins; compare runtime, mood, and language; remove or return.

DESIGN CHECK

Check: differences are legible and a small list stays manageable.

ITERATIONS INCLUDED

Empty-state recovery; Saved confirmation + My List; separate audio and subtitles; comparison capped at three. Scenario rehearsals produce no participant metrics.

APPENDIX

Source notes and submission integrity

Public sources support narrow product-context descriptions; concept choices and uncollected evidence are labeled separately.

Netflix recommendations
https://help.netflix.com/en/node/100639/

Netflix audio / subtitles
https://help.netflix.com/en/node/372

My Netflix / TV experience
https://help.netflix.com/en/node/321880164349028

Prime Video Help
https://www.primevideo.com/-/te/help?tr=gp

JioHotstar accessibility plan
https://secure-media.hotstar.com/web-assets/prod/accessibilityplan/ca/eng/accessibilityplan_ca_eng.html

4 FILES READY FOR GITHUB

Case study PDF, clickable index.html, research/validation kit, and GitHub-ready README with repository fields and upload steps.

Run real sessions before describing the concept as validated or claiming improved outcomes.